finding solution to climate changes and for many other reasons. Importance of reforestation is given below.

- Reforestation improves the quality of air we breathe by reducing carbon dioxide in it.
- The effects of deforestation can be checked and global warming can be reduced.
- Reforestation restores habitat loss, degradation and removes the threats to species.
- Forest restoration can reverse the damage done by soil erosion. Reforestation will revive the watersheds which are important aspects of environmental well-being.
- Reforestation maintains the water cycle of the area as trees absorb moisture through the leaves and roots.
- Transpiration of trees helps to restore the moisture of the atmosphere and to maintain the temperature in the local environment.

Table 22.1 Difference between Deforestation and Reforestation

Deforestation	Reforestation
When the plants or trees are cut down, it is called deforestation.	When the plants or trees are grown or planted, it is called reforestation.
Deforestation has a negative effect on the environment.	Reforestation has a very good effect on the nature, as it builds the environment.

Table 22.2 Differences between Afforestation and Reforestation

Afforestation	Reafforestation
Trees are planted in new areas where there was no forest cover.	It is practiced in areas where forests have been destroyed.
One sapling is planted to get one tree.	Two saplings are planted to replace every felled tree.
It is practiced to bring more area under forest.	It is practiced to avoid deforestation.

22.4 Endangered Species

Our country is a home for variety of species with rich flora and fauna. Flora is the plant life occurring in a particular area. Fauna is the animal life occurring in a particular area.The Royal Bengal Tigers, the Asiatic Cheetah and several other birds are found in India. But due to various reasons like environmental pollution, deforestation, loss of habitat, human interference, poaching and hunting many animals in India are extinct and many are endangered. Species which no longer exist on earth are called extinct species. E.g. Dinosaurs, Dodo. An endangered species is an animal or a plant that is considered to be at the risk of extinction. It means that there are only



Figure 22.6 Endangered Animals

Activity 4

Observe the following days in your school

World Forest Day	-	March 21
World Water Day	-	March 22
Environmental Day	-	June 5
World Nature Conservation Day	-	July 28
Ozone Day	-	September 16

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